AI-ASSISTED PRODUCT CASE STUDY · 2026

Lodestar

Rules do the sorting. The LLM does the judging.

Ekaterina Nikerova
Senior Product Manager · Lisbon
AdTech, ML personalization, e-commerce

7,661 listings collected, 4–7 Nov

4,086 unique vacancies in the same period

601 LLM evaluations to date (all runs)

11.3% GO + COND verdicts (68 of 601)

01 · The problem

Fragmented sources, duplicated listings, repeated manual screening and no memory of past decisions: the same job is reposted by agencies and in several countries, and I could not remember which ones I had read.

02 · The architecture

Collect LinkedIn, company boards, Telegram → **Rules** role, level, language, location, age → **Dedupe + memory** seen, agency copies, past decisions → **LLM verdict** GO / COND / NO, match %, reason → **Tracker** decisions and application status → **Audit** review rules and verdicts, fix, rerun

Hybrid AI screening pipeline: deterministic filtering + LLM judgment + human feedback loop. Green = code, orange = LLM.

CODE DECIDES

- Product-role titles only; drops Head-of, Director, Technical PM
- Drops vacancies older than 30 days; country and "hires from Europe" checks
- Hard stops: required language, experience level
- Dedupe by company + title + country; prioritises the direct employer over agency reposts
- Remembers every vacancy seen and hides decided ones
- Batches, parses verdicts, updates the tracker

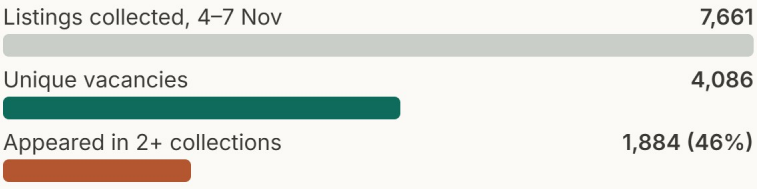
One run, 6 Nov: 1,429 collected → 31 prepared for LLM evaluation. Rules and dedupe removed 84%, memory 13%.

LLM DECIDES

- A Claude Project holds my screening framework and verified facts about my experience
- Does the role fit my background? Which requirements are real blockers?
- Returns a structured answer: verdict, match % and a one-line reason
- The program parses the response and attaches the verdict to the vacancy

601 scored: 17 GO, 51 COND, 533 NO. Only new vacancies that survive filtering, deduplication and memory checks are prepared for evaluation.

03 · Persistent memory prevents repeated work



Almost half of the unique vacancies came back in a later run. By hand, each one means opening it again and trying to recall the decision. Lodestar recognizes it and does not screen it twice.

04 · What didn't work

Two broad title rules ("platform" and "lead") were removing roles close to my experience. The LLM was not the cause. I found this by reviewing rejected vacancies, removed the broad patterns and reprocessed the affected listings. The impact is not yet quantified. **Human review catches systematic filtering errors.**

> **What I took from it:** automation is not about delegating everything to AI. It is about finding where deterministic logic is more reliable, cheaper and easier to audit than an LLM, and keeping the model for judgment.

Python · SQLite · Claude Project · Excel. Built with Claude as a coding assistant; architecture and screening criteria designed by Ekaterina. In use for my own job search: 40 applications tracked.

GitHub github.com/EkaterinaN20/lodestar-case
LinkedIn linkedin.com/in/ekaterina-nikerova19